Afghan tribes of his erstwhile kingdom, while Humayun's troops drew ever closer on his trail. After one particularly narrow escape, Kamran decided to try his luck in Hindustan, offering himself in alliance to Salim Shah, son of the Sher Shah who had chased Kamran's family out of Bengal, then Agra and Lahore. The son was no more favourable to the Timurids than his father; according to Abul Fazl, he treated Kamran worse than he would 'enemies or street-dogs', and it soon became clear that all the territory Kamran could reasonably expect from the Afghan king was a dungeon cell. He managed to escape, with some help from two rajas of Punjab and a disguise of women's clothes, and returned across the Indus to the court of Adam, sultan of the Gakkhar tribe.[60]

Deep in the winter of 1552, a messenger from Sultan Adam arrived in Humayun's court. He carried a letter, in which the sultan professed concern for Kamran's 'vagabond' state and a desire to 'do homage' to Humayun. The messenger's oral report was less circumspect: he told Humayun the whole sorry tale, including the fact that Kamran was trying to get Sultan Adam to join his rebellion.

It is some indication of Kamran's burning ambition that even now, reeling from defeat after defeat, abandoned by mercenaries and disdained by kings, he remained intent on his throne. And not even now, when Kamran was no more than the unwelcome guest of a distant tribe, could Humayun afford to think of his brother as a spent force. He hurried west, taking Akbar with him.

They made it just in time. According to Abul Fazl, Sultan Adam had developed 'misplaced apprehensions' when Humayun arrived, and it took some 'cajolery and stratagem' to remind him of his lately professed loyalty.[61] Kamran was taken prisoner, but now it was Humayun who seemed to be suffering a change of heart. His urgent journey west may have suggested that Kamran would meet the fate of Yadgar Nasir, or Askari. No bowstring, however, was coiled around Kamran's neck that night, no men dispatched him to Mecca in chains. Instead, Humayun invited him to a feast. Much as he had done after the siege of Taligan, Humayun called Kamran to sit by his side. There were no brothers to join them this time: it was Akbar, now ten, who sat on Humayun's other side. Jouher tells of how Humayun called for a watermelon and cut it in three parts, one each he gave